

Luxury Sales Training: Closing Deals Over The Phone

A Step By Step Guide

Lux Blueprint

This guide covers the exact script we use when we are on the phone with a homeowner. It works no matter how the lead came in. It could be a cold call, a reply on SmarterContact, or a call in from a direct mail piece. The words stay the same. The script is all about getting the right information and proving you are an expert who can do these kinds of deals. The full script is in the classroom under the Luxury Sales Masterclass. Pull it up and follow along as you read this guide.

First, Get Over The Fear Of The Phone

Everyone is scared of the phone at first. I was terrified when I started, and I knew it was a silly fear. Think about it. What is the worst that can happen? Nobody can reach through the phone and punch you. The worst case is somebody yells at you. If that happens, it says more about them than it does about you. That is a person having a bad day who is taking it out on a stranger. Say a silent prayer for them, hope their day gets better, and call the next person.

Here is the truth. The only way you will ever get good on the phone is by making phone calls. Picture two people who both want to get good at golf. For 30 days, one person reads every golf book, watches every video, and listens to Tiger Woods talk about the swing. The other person gets no instruction at all. He just goes to the range and hits balls every single day. Who plays better at the end of the month? The one who practiced. Every time.

My first phone call was terrible. My second one was even worse. After about 50 calls I started to feel comfortable. After 100 I had the swing of it. After 1,000 I felt good. Now I have made thousands of these calls, including live calls with a thousand people watching me. The secret is time plus a good process. That is it.

And remember this. You are calling from a place of value. You are being trained on the most up to date real estate investing techniques, and you are calling to help people get where they want to go. You are the one with the answers. Believe that.

If you want to warm up, role play with your spouse, a sibling, or somebody in the community. You can even talk to ChatGPT and have it play the seller. That is fine for a little bit. But real calls with real sellers will make you better faster than anything else, and they are the only calls that can turn into those \$100,000 paydays.

The Opening

Every call starts the same way, no matter what kind of lead it is.

"Hello, [First Name]?" (wait for them to answer) "Hey, I'm calling about your property over on [Street Name]. Did I catch you at a bad time?"

A few rules for the opening. Always call them by their first name, like you are talking to a friend. Do this even if a woman answers and you have a man's name on your screen. Worst case, she says that is my husband, or you have the wrong number. No worries. Move on.

Say the street name only. Never the full address. Say I'm calling about your property on Bluebird, and they know exactly which house you mean. They only own one house on Bluebird. Reading off the full address sounds like a telemarketer. Using the street name sounds like a person who knows the market. This one small thing makes you sound much more professional.

People ask me all the time if they should say good time or bad time. It does not matter. What matters is that you say it smoothly, without tripping over your words. If you are stumbling, that only means you have not practiced enough yet. Nobody starts as the graceful master. Everybody starts as the stumbling beginner. The best time to plant a tree was 50 years ago. The second best time is today. Get your reps in.

What If The Property Is Under A Trust Or LLC?

You will run into this a lot. You have no name to use. Do not ask for their name. Just say:

"Hi, I'm looking for the owner of [Full Address]. I'm calling about that property. Did I catch you at a bad time?"

This is the one time you use the full address. Then go straight into the positioning below so they hear right away that you will not waste their time with a lowball offer. People who hold property in trusts get lowball calls all the time. We get in front of that at the very start.

The Positioning

Once they say now is fine, or they ask what this is about, you go right into this:

"I'm working with a developer in your area and we are actively looking for our next project. We specialize in discreet purchases of higher end homes and redevelopment properties. No public listings, no open houses. I'm not here to waste your time, and I will not do so with a lowball offer. Is this an okay time?"

If they hesitate or say they are busy:

"Totally fine. This will take about 60 seconds, and you can tell me right away if it's not relevant to you."

If they already replied to a text on SmarterContact, everything stays the same. Just add a line like, hey, we were just texting about your property on Bluebird. Then repeat the whole positioning anyway. It does not matter that they already read it in a text. Say it again.

Bring The Energy

When I read this script, I channel my inner Jordan Belfort from the Wolf of Wall Street. Is it a little cringe? Yes. Do it anyway. Think about that scene where he teaches his salespeople. He has energy. He enunciates. He sounds curious and interesting. That is what you want.

If you read the script in a flat, bored voice, nobody wants to talk to you. Change your pace. Go up and down. Sound like somebody they would want to keep on the phone. And here is the thing. You can be interested for real, because you are. You are on the phone to help this person and make money together.

Bringing energy is a muscle. It is like your first day at the gym when eight curls wore you out. Keep showing up and it gets easier every week until it is just how you talk.

The Three Responses You Will Get

After the positioning, one of three things happens.

- They are interested. Great. Move on to the questions.
- They are not interested. Say, completely understand. Do you think anything might change in the future? If they say maybe in a few months, mark them as a lead, add a note, and set a follow up. If it is a hard no, no worries. We send campaigns to the same lists all the time and we will catch them again.
- They are the pushy Type A who says, just give me your offer. Handle this one with the lines below.

For the Type A seller, first say:

"We're going to get to that in just a second. All I need is to get a few questions answered about your property, and then I can give you my best offer. Is that all right?"

If they push one more time, hit them with this:

"Well, look, do you want my fast offer or do you want my best offer? I promise you'll like my best offer more."

If they say they want the fast offer, they were never serious about selling. Move on. If they say they want the best offer, say, perfect, I just need a couple of things answered and we will get that for you.

Smokescreens And The Tennis Match

Sellers throw up smokescreens. What is your offer? What company are you with? What developer do you work with? These questions do not mean what they say. Every single one of them really means the same thing. Are you legit, or are you full of it? That is what they are actually asking.

Smokescreens are always handled the same way, and your exact answer does not matter. You answer them the way a politician answers a question. A politician never really answers. He touches the question and routes it right back to his message. You do the same. For example, if they ask what developer you work with:

"We only work with the top developers, the ones doing the biggest and best projects in this area. That's a great question, what makes you ask?"

Now here is the rule behind that answer, and it might be the most important idea in this whole guide. A sales call is a tennis match. You score a point when the ball lands on their side and does not come back. In our game, that means you score a point every time you end what you say with a question. If they ask you something and you just answer it and stop talking, you dropped the ball. Now they are driving the conversation. The person asking the questions is always the one driving.

If you ever get stuck and cannot think of a question to ask, there is an easy fix. Your next question is just the next question on the script.

Listen More Than You Speak

You have two ears and one mouth. Use them in that ratio. People love to talk about themselves, and letting them talk is the fastest way to build rapport. Keep them going with little one liners. Oh really? And then what? Wait, are you serious? How did that make you feel? Never interrupt somebody while they are talking. Even if you are excited and have something to say, be quiet and let them finish. You want them to tell you everything they possibly can.

The Soft Interest Check

Now we start gathering information. This first question is meant to get them talking about the property and help us figure out why they might sell. Read the person you are talking to, because you will pick your question based on who they are.

If you have a talker on the phone, somebody with time who enjoys the chat, ask:

"How long have you owned the property?"

If you have a Type A, straight to the point person, skip that and ask:

"Do you have a plan for where you would go next? The only reason I ask is we can be very flexible with our timeline, and we can even offer sellers time after closing so there's no stress on your end."

Here is the hidden reason for that second question. On the surface, it checks whether they might want extra time after closing. But the real gold is what their answer tells you about the property. Do they live there? Is it a winter home? Is it rented out? Is it sitting vacant? You learn all of that without asking directly. Asking somebody straight out if they live in the house can feel creepy. This way it comes out naturally.

If they perk up at the idea of staying after closing, explain it and end with a question:

"Yeah, sometimes after closing you can get all the proceeds from the sale and still stay in the property for several months. Would that be something you'd want to hear more about?"

The Property Questions

These questions do two jobs. First, they get us the information we need to underwrite the deal and sell it to a developer. Second, they make us sound like a pro. Even if this is your very first real estate call, when you ask about slope, wash, or features that affect the buildable area, the seller thinks, this person knows what they are doing. The questions themselves prove you are the real deal.

Ask these conversationally, like you are chatting, and take notes on everything:

- "Do you happen to know the approximate lot size?"
- "Is the lot fairly rectangular, or does it have any irregular boundaries?"
- "Any slope, wash, or natural features that affect the buildable area?"
- "Are you aware of any easements on the property? Utilities, drainage, access, or a shared driveway?"
- "Have you ever run into setback limitations or restrictions when making improvements?"

- "Is the property subject to any deed restrictions, architectural guidelines, or neighborhood agreements?" (If they say they have an HOA, write that down.)
- "Do you know how the property is zoned?"
- "Do you know if it allows for expansion, guest homes, or potential lot splits?" (You can find gold with this one.)
- "Is the home on sewer or septic?"
- "Any known issues with utilities? Water, power, or gas?"
- "Is gas currently on site or nearby?"

If They Say "You Can Find That Online"

"I absolutely can, and I've got it pulled up right here. But we've found that even the county assessor gets it wrong sometimes, so we just want to make sure we have the correct information. It's showing here that it's one acre. Is that correct?"

Always say county assessor. Between you and me, I am looking at Zillow. County assessor sounds better. If they have no idea what the lot size is, say no worries, I can find the exact number easily, and move to the next question.

If They Act Like A Question Is Dumb

Some questions fit some markets and miss in others. Ask about septic in a place where nobody has septic and a seller might say, why would you even ask that? Easy. Pull the reverse card:

"I'm sorry, it's because we buy a lot of properties in several different markets, and our job is to be super thorough so we only have to have this conversation once."

Then move straight into your next question. Remember, we always answer a question with a question.

What Your Notes Must Capture

- Lot size (what the county says versus what is actually usable)
- Zoning or any overlay
- Easements or setbacks
- Sewer or septic
- Motivation (estate, downsizing, privacy, cashing out)
- Timing
- How sophisticated the seller is
- How emotionally attached they are to the property

The Gut Check Questions

At this point we have almost everything we need about the property. Now we find out how serious this person really is about selling and moving. You will usually ask one or two of these, based on how the conversation is flowing. Soften the entry with a thank you, like, I really appreciate you taking the time to answer those questions. Then:

- "If you ever did decide to sell, what would that next chapter look like for you?"
- "Is there a particular timing that would matter? Soon, later, or just whenever it makes sense?"
- "What would need to happen for selling to feel worthwhile?"

That last one is sneaky good. Chris Voss talks about the black swan in negotiation. It is the one piece of information that changes everything, the thing that tells you what really drives this person. This question finds it.

Watch where they go with their answer. If they jump straight to price and say, we would need at least 3 million, get curious. Why 3 million? What does that number let you do? Maybe it nets them enough for the next house plus some breathing room. If they jump to timing and say, we need to be out by the end of the month, ask, what is it about the end of the month that helps you out? Maybe the kids and the school year. Whatever it is, keep pulling the thread.

Stay curious. Wonder why they are saying what they are saying. That curiosity is what makes a seller think, this person actually cares about my situation. He is another caller who turned out to be a real human. That is how rapport gets built, and rapport closes deals.

Getting A Price

Here is how we ask about price:

"I'm not asking for a firm number, but if you had to ballpark it, where do you think the property might trade privately?"

Matthew wrote this question and it is genius. It is casual and third party, like you are asking your buddy what he thinks his boat will sell for. It feels so friendly that people just answer it. Especially that ending, trade privately. Beautiful.

In traditional wholesaling I was a juggernaut about price. If I got you on the phone, I was getting a number out of you no matter what. Luxury is different. The number is nice to have, but what matters most here is confirming they truly want to sell. So if they push back and say, you called me, you make an offer, stay relaxed:

"No problem at all. We usually focus on structure and options first before dialing in the numbers."

Notice what happened there. They asked a question. You answered it like a politician and moved to your next question. Ball back on their side.

How We Operate

Luxury sellers care about how the deal feels. This is where we sell certainty, privacy, and flexibility:

"Just so you know how we work, everything is handled discreetly, we typically cover seller costs, and we work around your timeline."

"Some sellers prefer certainty, privacy, and flexibility over listing publicly. If it ever made sense, we could outline options like selling as is, so you don't have to worry about repairs or disclosures, a delayed closing, or even a potential leaseback."

Pause between those lines. Let them react. If they light up at selling as is, write that down. If they ask, wait, what does a delayed closing mean, write that down. If a leaseback catches their ear, ask about it. Why? Is that something that would be important to you? Paint me a picture. If we could do something like that, what would the dream scenario look like for you? Every reaction here is a clue about what will close this deal later.

The Soft Close

"Do you think it would make sense for me to take a deeper look and come back with a few private options? Purely informational."

This line is vague on purpose. We never say the word offer here. We want them to say it. When they ask, what do you mean, like make me an offer on the property, you say, yeah, absolutely, if that is what you are ready for. Now making the offer is their idea. That is the Jedi mind trick. People are far more willing to go along with a plan when it is their plan.

Teeing Up The Offer

"Sounds good. Thank you so much for being patient with me and answering my questions. I'm going to take this information and use it to formulate our offer for your property. Once I have everything ready, would you prefer I call you back, or send the offer by text or email?"

In traditional wholesaling I never would have offered a choice like this. I pushed for a contract on the first call every time. Luxury moves slower, and that is fine. The one call close is rare in this game. Think of us as the Four Seasons or the Ritz Carlton of selling your home to an investor. White glove service. We do things the way the client wants them done.

Whatever they pick, confirm the best contact information. If they say email, ask, is this the best email I have on file, or what is the best one to send it to? If they say text, ask, is this the best number, or should I include your spouse in a group text? A lot of times you called an office line or a landline. We want their cell and their best email.

They may ask if the offer will be a real contract. Their idea again. Say, absolutely, we will get it typed up and send you an official agreement. Give them whatever they ask for, and keep it vague until they ask, because people love going along with their own plan.

Making The Offer On The Phone

"Hello, [First Name], this is [Your Name] calling you back with an offer for your property on [Street Name]. Is now a good time?" ... "Fantastic. I'll keep this short and sweet for you. Please keep in mind these numbers are net to you. There are no commissions or closing costs on your end. Not to mention it's an as is sale, so you don't have to worry about fixing anything or making any disclosures. That being said, our approved offer for your property is [\$X,XXX,XXX]."

If you learned during the first call that they wanted a leaseback or extra time, fold those terms into that little speech before the number.

Then comes the most important rule of the entire offer call. Say the price and then be quiet. Do not say another word. They will probably go quiet too, because they are thinking. Do not interrupt that silence. The Wolf of Wall Street line is, whoever speaks first loses. Say your number and shut up until they speak.

The 1.08 Math

Do this before every single offer call. Open your calculator app, type in your offer price, and multiply it by 1.08. Why? Because when somebody sells on the market, they pay around 8 percent in commissions and closing costs. So a 3 million dollar offer times 1.08 is 3,240,000 dollars. That means if they sold on the market for 3,240,000 dollars, they would net about 3 million, which is exactly what you are offering. Have that on market number written down and ready before you dial. You will need it for the rebuttals below.

The Rebuttals

These are situational. Use them when they fit.

Rebuttal 1: When They Want More

They say something like, we were really hoping to be at 3.5. You say:

"I do want you to keep in mind that, like I said, these numbers are net to you. There are no commissions or closing costs on your end, and that alone saves you 7 to 8 percent. So really, our offer is the same as if you had sold on the market for [your offer times 1.08]."

Rebuttal 2: When They Question The Number

They say, I have no idea how you even got to that number. You say:

"I completely understand where you're coming from. For us, this is a simple math equation. We know, based on your lot, how big and nice of a property we can build, and what comparable properties of that size sell for in your neighborhood. We plug those numbers in, and our offer is what came out. Does that make sense?"

Notice the ending. Always end in a question, even in a rebuttal. This one also does something powerful. It takes an emotional moment and turns it logical. They already know you are an investor. They already know something big is getting built. You are just showing them the math.

The Re-Education: Act Confused On Purpose

Sometimes a seller is way off on value and you have to walk them back to reality. There is an art to this. Never come across as a know it all, and never tell them they are wrong. You want them to figure it out on their own, because then it is their idea.

The way I do it is by playing confused. I act completely floored by what they said. Say I offered 3 million because comps on their street sell around 3.3 or 3.4. They fire back, that is outrageous, we could easily get 3.8. Here is me:

"Whoa, I'm sorry, hold up. This is news to me. I must be missing something. What am I missing here? Shoot, are you in front of your computer? I've got Zillow pulled up right now and I'm looking at the area. Is there something that traded off market that you know about and I don't? Because I see your neighbor down the street sold for 3.2, and after fees they netted less than the 3 million I'm offering you. There is one sale at 3.8, but that lot is an acre and a half. Am I missing something else?"

You are the lost puppy who needs their help to understand. So they go look. And when they look, they see the same numbers you see. Here is why this works. People love explaining things to somebody. Teaching you something makes them like you more. I play confused all the time, with sellers and with developers, and because I ask instead of acting like I know everything, I also learn a ton.

One catch. You can only re educate somebody if you know the numbers cold. That means you must know how to underwrite these properties. If you have not learned that yet, go through How To Analyze A Deal in the classroom and keep it open while you work leads. It teaches you exactly how to figure out what a developer will pay.

Sending The Offer By Text Or Email

If they asked for the offer in writing, keep it super simple:

[First Name], our offer is as outlined below.

Purchase Price:

EMD:

Close of Escrow:

Additional Terms:

Please keep in mind these numbers are net to you. There are no commissions or closing costs on your end. This alone saves you 7 to 8 percent, so our offer is the same as if you had sold on the market for [your offer times 1.08].

One important rule about EMD. Only put EMD on the offer if you are willing and able to put up a real amount, around 1 percent. On a 3 million dollar deal, that is 30,000 dollars. If you are new and you do not have that, or you do not want to get transactional funding yet, just leave the EMD line off. We will cross that bridge when we get to it.

How You Actually Get Good At This

Record your calls and listen to them. This is how I trained myself. I would call all day, then pick two or three calls, maybe my longest one, my best one, and my worst one. On the drive home I would listen and take notes. Oh man, they asked me a question, I just answered it, and I dropped the ball. Why did I say that? Why did I interrupt her? You will learn more from your own recordings than from anything else.

Is it boring? Yes. It is the most boring thing in the world. It is like practicing bunker shots in golf. Nobody wants to sit in the sand. But every pro on tour has spent hundreds of hours in the sand, because that is what it takes to be the best.

The Wrap Up

Follow these rules on every call:

- Bring high energy. Be somebody they want to talk to.
- End everything you say with a question. That keeps you in the driver's seat.
- Listen more than you speak, and never interrupt.

- Take notes on every conversation so you fully understand what happened.
- When you say your price, be quiet until they speak.

Do these things and sellers will like you, you will get all the information you need, and you will come across as a professional. That is how deals get closed over the phone.